



2ND WEEK: **DAY 9**

Focus on you

YOUR BABY TODAY

If your baby vomits large amounts and isn't thriving, this may suggest a problem such as [gastroesophageal reflux](#). This is caused by the immaturity of the stomach muscles and does resolve over time and with treatment.

“Now that you’ve begun to adapt to the topsy-turvy world of motherhood, try to carve out some time for yourself each day.”

To help you deal with broken nights and constant demands, you need to develop coping skills, such as taking an afternoon nap. You may also be dealing with feelings of isolation and may even find it hard to keep track of what day it is as days and nights merge into one. To revive your spirits, arrange for a friend or relative to take care of your baby while you have a break. You and your partner also need to make more of an effort to make time for each other.

BREASTFEEDING PROBLEMS

For some women, breastfeeding is a straightforward process, but for many women, it can be surprisingly hard. Engorged (swollen) breasts and sore nipples are a common complaint; knowing how to avoid or treat these problems can be the difference between continuing with breastfeeding and giving up.

The secret to avoiding sore nipples is to make sure that your baby [latches on](#) to your breast properly. Engorged breasts can make it hard for your baby to latch on, so try expressing a little milk (see [Successful breastfeeding](#)) before a feeding to relieve some pressure. Whenever possible, let the air get to your nipples, and use breast pads at other times to keep the nipples dry.

You can relieve engorged breasts by continuing with breastfeeding and expressing milk frequently between feedings to relieve the pressure. Placing a warm, clean washcloth on your breast or putting a chilled cabbage leaf inside your bra can also be soothing.